

Make notes as you create

Project Notes, an application module for adding documentation or written content, comes with Proteus. This free-form editor lets you add whatever you wish to, in the style you choose. There are available templates for engineering change orders, PCB specifications and the like. You can even link these to real components on the system, providing a quick look-up table, if need be. It also turns out to be a handy navigation tool.

using a component separator option, or even re-arranging the pins, while preserving boundary scan description language file as it is.

PCB layout uses LPC standard footprint, but you can create your own custom footprint using tools like PCB Library Export and import the pad's ASCII format into Proteus. If being used in a field-programmable gate array, change in pin-mapping can be loaded into the package tool and then used to update Proteus with the latest details. The only requirement is that the PCB net classes and design rules should be set up before starting with the layout, so as to keep the tool informed of the next alpha traces and aid manoeuvring between high pin devices.

Design rules can also be custom-generated according to the entire design for net classes, trace and via styles, clearances and more. At pre-production stage, the PCB tool runs a quality-assurance check, checks for power plane geometry and integrity, and tests to spot common design errors.

The bombarded view and the BOM

A 3D viewer lets you see your PCB in all its fullness. Apart from simply looking at your board from a 3D viewpoint, this feature can strip down the design to a bare board, letting you inspect tracks and vias or zoom in on a specific part. With built-in standard for the exchange of product model data and initial graphics exchange specification support, you can import these models to view your components in 3D and export your whole board at the end,

to use with any mechanical computer-aided design tool.

The thing about bill of materials (BOM) in Proteus is the fact that it is fully customisable. You can work with multiple components at once and, more importantly, generate it in the style used by the company in question.

Kicking grounds backstage

Proteus has been put to good use in various industry segments, right from design to verification. Electronic airfield ground equipment, underground pipeline corrosion engineering, vehicle dashboards, musical instrument digital interface converters and Hi-Z USB audio interfaces, truck braking systems and industrial elevators are some of the areas Proteus has found its way into.

With features and flexible licensing, Proteus is also an in-demand tool at colleges to aid courses dealing with electronics, microcontrollers and PCB designing.

Proteus Lite is a shareware-licensed tear-down version of the original, providing limited but meaningful functionality. Built for Windows, Proteus 8.5 is the latest release from the team that is making a presence at major conferences.

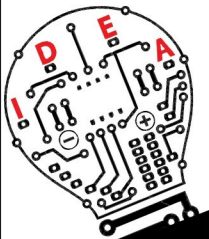
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electronics
plus

Original, innovative circuit ideas are invited

from designers and
experimenters
for publication in EFY magazine



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